

AI Carbon Tracker Project

Full-Stack Data Engineering Documentation

1. The Conceptual Architecture

This project implements a real-time data pipeline. Data flows from a simulated hardware sensor (Emitter) to a web server (FastAPI), is stored in a relational database (PostgreSQL), and is finally analyzed via a dashboard.

- **Producer:** Python script simulating GPU power draw.
- **Ingestion:** FastAPI handling HTTP POST requests.
- **Storage:** PostgreSQL using a Star Schema (Fact and Dimension tables).
- **Analytics:** Aggregation logic to calculate Costs and CO2.

2. Database Setup (pgAdmin 4)

A. Create the Database

1. Open pgAdmin 4.
2. Right-click **Databases** > **Create** > **Database...**
3. Name: `carbon_tracker_db`.

B. Define the Schema (Star Schema)

We used two tables linked by a `hardware_id`.

```
-- 1. Dimension Table: Hardware Info
CREATE TABLE dim_hardware (
    hardware_id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
    name VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
    type VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL,
    tdp_watts INTEGER
);
```

```
-- 2. Fact Table: Energy Logs
CREATE TABLE fact_compute_logs (
  log_id SERIAL PRIMARY KEY,
  job_id VARCHAR(50),
  hardware_id INTEGER REFERENCES dim_hardware(hardware_id),
  power_draw_watts FLOAT,
  timestamp TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);
```

C. Seed Initial Data

You manually inserted the "NVIDIA A100" so the logs had something to join against:

```
INSERT INTO dim_hardware (name, type, tdp_watts) VALUES ('NVIDIA A100', 'GPU', 400);
```

3. Application Setup

A. Project Structure

Organizing code into an `app/` package for professional modularity:

```
carbon_tracker_project/
├── app/
│   ├── routes/tracking.py
│   ├── database.py
│   ├── models.py
│   ├── schemas.py
│   ├── main.py
│   └── dashboard.py
├── .env
├── .gitignore
└── test_emitter.py
```

B. Security & Environment

We moved the `DATABASE_URL` to a `.env` file to keep the password safe from GitHub.

```
DATABASE_URL=postgresql+asyncpg://postgres:PASSWORD@localhost:5432/carbon_tracker
```

4. The Logic (Python Implementation)

Models (SQLAlchemy)

Mapping database tables to Python classes. We used `Mapped` and `mapped_column` for modern type-hinting.

The Analytics Calculation

The dashboard performs the following math:

$$\text{Total kWh} = (\Sigma \text{Power Watts} \times 1 \text{ second}) / 3600 / 1000$$

$$\text{Cost} = \text{Total kWh} \times \$0.16$$

$$\text{CO2} = \text{Total kWh} \times 0.4 \text{ kg}$$

5. Deployment & Version Control

A. Git Initialization

We initialized Git and used a `.gitignore` to hide `.env` and `__pycache__`.

B. GitHub Push

Commands used to upload the code:

```
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit"
git push origin main
```

Summary of Learned Skills

Concept	Technology
Asynchronous Programming	Python <code>asyncio</code>
REST API Ingestion	FastAPI
Relational DB Joins	SQL / SQLAlchemy
Secret Management	Environment Variables (.env)